

bubbles, live music, crafts, and booths from local businesses.

One recurring attraction, Maniac Pumpkin Carvers, has been a mainstay at Addams Family Fun Day since the beginning. Founded by friends Chris Soria and Marc Evan, the company uses pumpkins as canvases, carving all sorts of designs to fit AddamsFest's yearly theme. "A lot of people really appreciate the artwork," Soria says. "It's a great opportunity for us to share our craft with people."

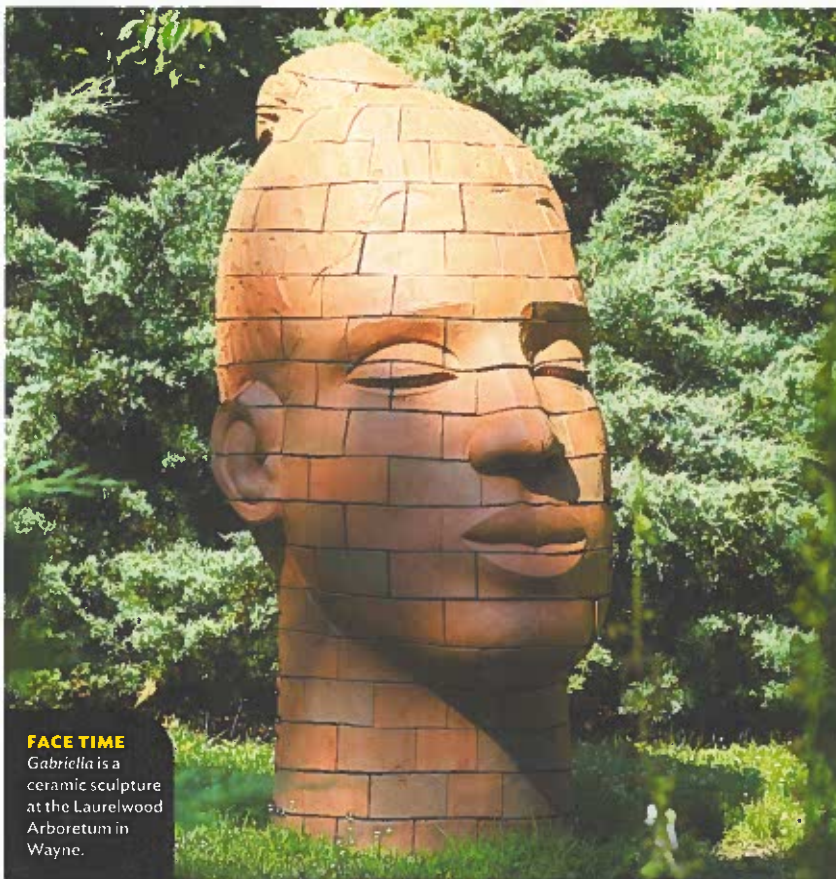
A Morticia-and-Gomez-themed masquerade ball, where guests get decked out as Addams Family characters, takes place on October 10 at the James Ward Mansion.

The festival's inception came about seven years ago, when creator and chairperson Dawn Mackey, then in her first days as a Westfield councilwoman, took inspiration from BlobFest, an annual festival in Phoenixville, Pennsylvania, where the 1958 movie *The Blob* was filmed. Westfield's adaptation, a tribute to its most famous former resident, was a no-brainer, and plans for a month-long Addams celebration soon commenced.

Baked into the festival is an appreciation for the cartoonist's upbringing in Westfield and his lasting impact on pop culture. In 1938, he created the Addams Family characters as a cartoonist for *The New Yorker*, which famously spawned several movies and TV shows over the years, including the current hit, *Wednesday*.

An interesting piece of Addams's early art can still be seen in town. As a teenager in the 1920s, Addams graffitied a skel-

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FACE TIME
Gabriella is a ceramic sculpture at the Laurelwood Arboretum in Wayne.

TAKE IT OUTSIDE

These sculpture gardens integrate artwork made of stainless steel, stone, bronze and more into lush Garden State landscapes, offering outdoor galleries to stroll at your own pace.

BY RON SHIPMON

LAURELWOOD ARBORETUM'S SCULPTURE TRAIL

Wayne

This 30-acre botanical jewel's walking trail showcases 15 sculptures. Behind this visionary trail are Laurelwood volunteers and Pines Lake residents Stuart and Leslie Reiser, whose dedication fueled the project.

Curated by Scott A. Broadfoot, the sculptures are available for purchase, with a portion of the proceeds donated to the arboretum. Guided tours are available.

725 Pines Lake Drive West. Daily, 8 AM until dusk. Golf carts are available. laurelwoodarboretum.org. Entrance is free; donations are accepted.

CLIFTON ARTS CENTER AND SCULPTURE PARK

Clifton

The narrative of the Clifton Art Center and Sculpture Park began in 1994 with the vision and dedication of former mayor and councilwoman Gloria Kolodziej. Following the passing of her husband, Kolodziej embarked on civic leadership that championed the arts. Kolodziej, along with a team of supporters, transformed a 26-acre municipal parcel into an outdoor-gallery park.

Clifton's Sculpture Park, one of the few municipal art parks in the nation, has laid the groundwork for an indoor arts center as well. The 26-acre municipal complex has

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SPOOKY

events around town

WITCH-CRAFT
Paradise Lakes Campgrounds, Hammonton
This adults-only fest features costume contests, fortune telling and more. Camp overnight for added fun.

Dates: OCT 10-11
Admission: \$27 and up
Info: witchcraftnj.com